



Civic Meeting Report

Muncie Sanitary District Meeting April 16th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hhy2P8ejq9I
Publication Date	2025-04-16T15:50:01Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Board of Sanitary Commissioners

Date: April 16, 2025

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners was called to order on the morning of April 16, 2025, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - Presiding Officer: Not explicitly named in transcript (Meeting Chair)
 - Members Present: All sanitary commissioners present; no excused absences.
 - Members Absent: None.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The board considered the minutes from the April 2, 2025, meeting. A motion to approve was made and seconded, and the minutes were **Approved by Voice Vote**.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:09 Consideration of Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Presiding Officer / Sanitary Commission
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed a register of claims totaling \$983,593.96. The presiding officer highlighted a specific \$17,500 charge from My Tree Sons for performing approximately 600 feet of clearing related to the levee system. This work is required by the Corps of Engineers to keep the toe of the levee clear within a 15-foot boundary, executed under an existing indefinite quantity/indefinite delivery contract procured through public works.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:01:14 Rick Yenser**, Newsman and author.
 - *Concerns Addressed:* Discussed recent changes in local government taxes and revenue, urging local governments to live within their means and halt excessive taxation and borrowing. Highlighted that Senate Bill 1 (signed by the governor) will cost local governments approximately a billion dollars. Acknowledged the sanitary district's important work in cleaning the river and managing trash, but cautioned that accumulated debt and recent sewer rate increases have drawn public frustration and prompted legislative pushback.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **District Administrator Update (00:04:23 - Rick Conrad):**
 - *Traffic/Construction:* Noted active construction sites affecting traffic on Petty (between Brier and Dwayne) and near Martin Luther King and Hines.

- *Weather Event:* Reported on significant rainfall between April 4th and 7th (totaling ~4 inches), which caused the river gauge to rise past the 9-foot flood stage and crest at 12.5 feet. Praised Tom Noble and the engineering department for round-the-clock preparation and response. Noted a temporary road closure and successful water clearance at State Road 32 / East Jackson Street. Mentioned upcoming expenses for removing heavy, water-logged woody debris left along the levee.
- *Pollution Control Facility:* Announced a kickoff meeting with the TY Lin group to evaluate the pollution control facility and explore treatment capacity improvements (currently 38 million gallons per day vs. ~10 million gallons of actual sewage daily, with the remainder driven by combined storm/sewer stormwater runoff).
- *Public Events:*
 - Shred day at East Central Recycling (701 East Centennial) from April 21st to April 25th, 8:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m.
 - River cleanup on Earth Day (April 22nd) at 9:00 a.m. meeting at the Cardinal Greenway Depot (700 East Wiser), in partnership with the Muncie Stormwater Partnership (MIDY) and Muncie Delaware Clean and Beautiful.
 - Rain barrel workshop on Earth Day evening (April 22nd) at 6:00 p.m. (registration required).
- *Recycling Update:* Sanitation recycling plant can now accept milk, juice, and soup cartons (previously excluded due to waxy coatings).
- *Legislative Impact:* Addressed Senate Bill 1, noting that it will reduce property tax income (specifically affecting the sanitation department), though impacts are still being evaluated.
- **Board Member Comments:**
 - Commissioners expressed appreciation for the engineering department's proactive flood response.
 - The presiding officer shared an expression of gratitude from Muncie Chief of Police Nathan Sloan regarding assistance provided by the sanitation and engineering departments.
- **Adjournment:** A motion and second were offered to adjourn the meeting. **Approved by Voice Vote** (time of adjournment not explicitly stated).